

Biodiversity Hotspots & Global Conventions

Hotspot criteria and CBD/CITES/CMS/Nagoya purpose map for Prelims.

Portion focus ~72% · Topic: env-biodiversity

PYQ themes: Hotspots · CBD · CITES · Nagoya · CMS

Why this portion (PYQ lens)

Portion chance ~72%. Steady; pairs with protected-areas. Parent ~85%.

Years appeared (synthesis): 2016, 2017, 2018, 2019, 2020, 2021, 2022, 2023, 2024, 2025

Why UPSC asks this

Definitional criteria + treaty purpose one-liners are easy to mark.

Syllabus framing

Portion chance ~72%. Steady; pairs with protected-areas. Parent ~85%. This portion sits inside env-biodiversity and centres on biodiversity hotspots and global environment conventions. Definitional criteria + treaty purpose one-liners are easy to mark.

Recurring PYQ angles: Hotspots, CBD, CITES, Nagoya, CMS. Approximate appearance years in the 2016-2025 educational synthesis: 2016, 2017, 2018, 2019, 2020, 2021, 2022, 2023, 2024, 2025. Use the chance percentage only to sequence study hours - it is not an official prediction.

Core map of biodiversity hotspots and global environment conventions

Hotspot criteria: High endemism + habitat loss/threat thresholds. India-related hotspots: Himalaya, Western Ghats, Indo-Burma, Sundaland (Nicobar).

Endemism: Species restricted to a region. CBD: Conservation, sustainable use, benefit sharing.

Hold this core map as your elimination spine before memorising peripheral CA overlays.

Core concepts and definitions

Nagoya Protocol: Access and benefit sharing. CITES: International trade regulation via appendices.

CMS: Migratory species cooperation. Cartagena Protocol: Biosafety/LMOs - distinct from Nagoya.

Institutions, processes and mechanisms

Protected area != hotspot: Scientific label vs legal tool. Benefit sharing: Genetic resources and TK ethics.

Appendices idea: Different trade strictness. Migratory flyways: Birds link CMS and wetlands.

India angle and applied examples

ABS India: Biodiversity Act outline. Marine biodiversity: Reefs/mangroves/EEZ.

Invasive alien species: CBD concern. Aichi to GBF: Targets evolve - verify CA labels.

Comparisons, linkages and discriminators

Community knowledge: PBR idea. Synthetic biology edge: Headline awareness only.

India angle

Western Ghats endemism examples + NBA outline.

Question patterns and exam spine

Hotspot definition; convention -> purpose match.

Revision spine: Criteria -> India list -> convention table -> ABS/biosafety split.

Eliminate anachronisms and category errors first, then test remaining options against table rows and must-remember triggers.

Trap watch-list (specific)

Avoid: Every forest is a hotspot unit. Avoid: Cartagena=Nagoya. Avoid: CITES bans all trade. Avoid: CBD=UNFCCC.

Convention purposes

Instrument | Purpose

CBD -- Biodiversity triad

Nagoya -- ABS

Cartagena -- Biosafety

CITES -- Trade

CMS -- Migratory

Map / list facts

- Western Ghats
- Eastern Himalaya
- Nicobar

Common traps

- x Every forest is a hotspot unit
- x Cartagena=Nagoya
- x CITES bans all trade
- x CBD=UNFCCC

Must remember

- Hotspot criteria
- India hotspot list
- CBD triad
- Nagoya != Cartagena
- CITES=trade

Quick revision checklist

- [] Criteria
- [] India list
- [] 5 conventions
- [] 2 traps
- [] 10 MCQs

Educational prioritisation heuristic - not an official UPSC prediction. (c) UPSC IAS Study Hub original notes.